



Partly sunny, breezy 86/67 • Tomorrow: Cloudy 77/58 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, APRIL 19, 2025 • \$4

Early deal takes shape for stadium at RFK site

Commanders, D.C. in talks for \$3.2 billion public-private project

BY MEAGAN FLYNN AND SAM FORTIER

D.C. taxpayers would pay more than \$800 million toward the major redevelopment of RFK Stadium in a preliminary agreement with the Washington Commanders, according to D.C. Council Chairman Phil Mendelson (D), who said he was briefed by the mayor about the details this week.

While the city and the team are close to a deal, two people familiar with negotiations told The Washington Post earlier this week, it has not been finalized and it's unclear how or if numbers may change. Mendelson and some residents oppose the use of public funds for any part of the stadium.

Under the preliminary agreement, a stadium would anchor a large development at the 174-acre site including hotels, housing, some retail and possibly office space, plus parking facilities, Mendelson said. The overall cost of the stadium development would be \$3.2 billion — the majority of which would be paid for by the Commanders, which would put up a minimum of \$2.5 billion, Mendelson said. D.C.'s contribution would be \$500 million. EventsDC — D.C.'s convention and sports authority — would put up \$181 million for a parking facility, the chairman said.

The Commanders would also fund a parking facility, which D.C. would buy from the team in 2032 for \$175 million, Mendelson said. Combined with EventsDC's portion, the costs to taxpayers add up to a total of \$856 million. NBC4 first reported on the preliminary financial details of the deal Wednesday.

The team — which currently plays in Landover, Maryland — SEE STADIUM ON A2

A Good Friday ritual



MARCO LONGARI/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Worshippers of varied denominations in Durban, South Africa, carry a cross during a Good Friday procession commemorating Jesus' crucifixion by Romans. In Paris, four months after its long-awaited reopening, Notre Dame Cathedral welcomed devotees and tourists alike on Friday for an emotional ceremony ahead of Easter Sunday.

Some migrants reverse their false 'dead' status

After DOGE effort, they go to Social Security to prove they're alive

BY HANNAH NATANSON, LISA REIN AND MERYL KORNFELD

Immigrants falsely labeled dead by the Social Security Administration are showing up at field offices with documents proving they are alive, leading staff to reinstate nearly three

dozen people over the past week, according to records obtained by The Washington Post.

The immigrants who have requested a reversal and been reinstated in Social Security databases include a Haitian asylum seeker and a child, the records show. Some immigrants have shown up with driver's licenses and work permits to prove their legitimacy, the records show. Others have arrived bearing letters of notification that they received from their states declaring them dead.

The reversals come after the Department of Homeland Security SEE SOCIAL SECURITY ON A4

Trump set to 'move on' if no Ukraine deal soon

Rubio's remarks in Paris reflect president's growing frustration

BY ADAM TAYLOR, ROBYN DIXON AND ELLEN FRANCIS

PARIS — President Donald Trump is ready to "move on" from peace talks between Ukraine and Russia if there is no progress "within days," Secretary of State Marco Rubio told reporters Friday.

Rubio's remarks reflected how the U.S.-sponsored peace efforts have stalled and the president's frustration with the talks has grown. Though Trump said during his campaign that he could end the war within 24 hours, he is now almost three months into his second term. The administration's main achievement — an agreement by both sides to pause strikes on energy infrastructure for 30 days — is near its end and hasn't stopped lethal attacks in Ukraine.

"The president has spent 87 days at the highest level of this government repeatedly taking ef-

SEE UKRAINE ON A10

Senator recounts deportee meeting

MARYLAND MAN IS 'TRAUMATIZED'

Moved out of notorious prison, Van Hollen says

BY SILVIA FOSTER-FRAU, THEODORIC MEYER AND MAEGAN VAZQUEZ

Kilmar Abrego García, a father and husband who was mistakenly deported to a megaprison in El Salvador, was transferred to a different facility nine days ago after spending weeks in a cell with 25 other migrants, Sen. Chris Van Hollen (D-Maryland) said on Friday.

Van Hollen spoke from Washington Dulles International Airport upon his return from El Salvador, where he was able to meet with Abrego García on Thursday after being rebuffed by the Salvadoran government multiple times. The senator said the meeting at his hotel was the first time Abrego García — a longtime Maryland resident whose wife and children are U.S. citizens — had spoken to anyone from the outside world since being deported.

"He's experienced trauma, he said he's sad every day," Van Hollen said. "But I think this persistence resulted in having this chance to meet with him, to begin to get a little bit of his story, and I think it is the first step to ultimately bringing him home, as the Constitution requires."

The Supreme Court has ordered the Trump administration to "facilitate" the return of Abrego García, 29, to the United States, after the government acknowledged in court filings that a 2019 court order forbade his removal to El Salvador. But Trump administration officials have not taken the necessary steps to comply with the order, a lower court judge ruled this

SEE DEPORTEE ON A6

White House calls lab leak 'true' covid origin

Trump administration embraces the disputed theory on new website

BY DAN DIAMOND AND LAUREN WEBER

The White House on Friday launched a website deeming a laboratory leak as the "true" origin of the coronavirus, embracing a theory that has become a popular explanation for a pandemic that has killed more than 1 million Americans but remains divisive in the intelligence community and is opposed by many virologists.

The new website, which features an image of President Donald Trump striding between the words "Lab Leak," appears to draw entirely upon a report overseen by House Republicans last year that concluded the outbreak began with a lab leak in China. The White House site also echoes the report's allegations that Anthony S. Fauci, a former senior National Institutes of Health official who became a target of Trump's ire, "prompted" scientists to instead focus on a possible "natural" ex-

planation for the outbreak that included a potential virus spreading to humans from a Wuhan market where wild animals were sold.

"By nearly all measures of science, if there was evidence of a natural origin it would have *already surfaced*. But it hasn't," the White House website reads, encouraging visitors to download the embedded House Republicans' report.

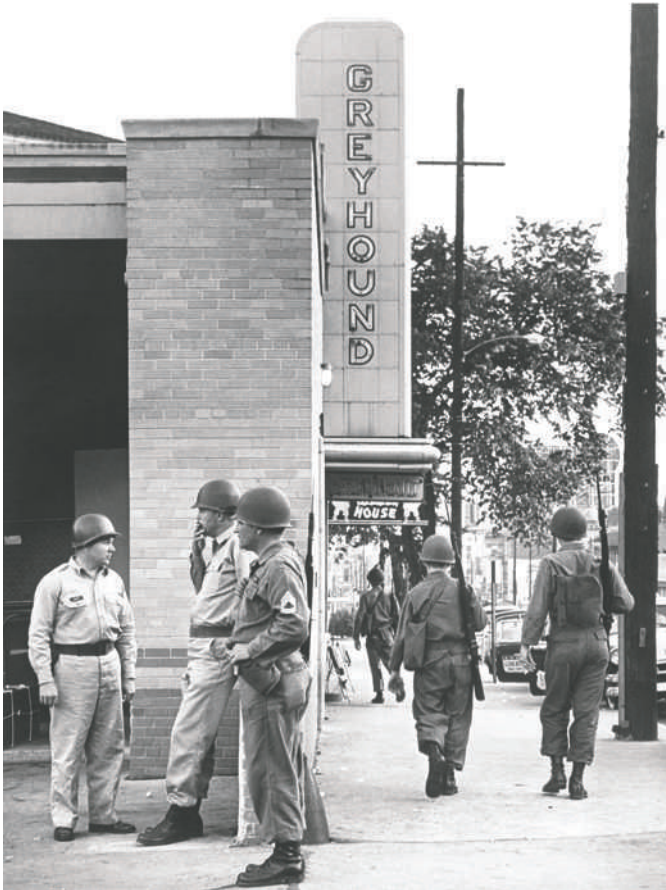
Five years after the nation shut down to combat the novel coronavirus, the virus's threat has receded — but the fights over pandemic policy have not. Trump and his allies have blamed advice from Fauci and other federal officials for some of the harshest measures, such as social distancing rules that led to school shutdowns and business closures. Democrats have blamed Trump's own efforts to initially downplay the virus's threat and his hesitation to encourage supporters to seek out lifesaving coronavirus vaccines. States are fighting the Trump administration's attempt to claw back more than \$11 billion in coronavirus funds from their health departments, saying it will weaken their ability to respond to public health threats.

SEE COVID ON A9

A civil rights marker on DOGE's chopping block

Fight ensues after Alabama museum commemorating 1961 Freedom Rides is targeted for sale

BY MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE IN MONTGOMERY, ALA.



1961 PHOTO BY BETTMANN ARCHIVE

Montgomery's Greyhound bus depot, where a mob attacked segregation protesters, is now the Freedom Rides Museum.

The bus station's "colored entrance" has vanished: door bricked over, scattered holes where a sign once hung. Though standing just inches away on the sidewalk, the students might not have even noticed it, had the museum director not highlighted the "ghost of segregation."

The building, he explained, was telling them a story.

Some clues were more obvious. On a wall beside the high-schoolers, dozens of mug shots stared back. These were Freedom Riders, Alexander Strickland told the group, and most of those who came here in 1961 were only a few years older than the teens. Yet they drafted their wills before boarding buses heading south to protest segregated seating and services in interstate travel.

"They were attacked by a mob of hundreds of people right where we're standing. They were willing to die," Strickland said as the students listened closely, imagining the scene. "You're standing where history happened."

This was the lesson that their teacher had brought them here

to learn — and that she feared could soon be lost.

Lisa Harmon had read about the Trump administration's plan to sell the former bus depot, which the museum leases from the federal government. Harmon teaches AP African American history at John Adams College and Career Academy, a public school on Cleveland's east side. She had become alarmed in recent years as lawmakers across the country attacked the curriculum for being "critical race theory" and even banned it in Florida. But closing a national landmark?

"Why would they target this place as government waste?" she asked Strickland once he'd finished the tour. "This is American history."

Amid U.S. DOGE Service-driven cuts by the General Services Administration, the agency that manages federal property, officials included the building on a list of hundreds they planned to sell because they were "not core to government operations."

"Selling ensures that taxpayer dollars are no longer spent on vacant or underutilized federal

SEE SITES ON A14

IN THE NEWS

Immigration case A U.S.-born citizen was detained in Florida and held for 24 hours in a county jail as an 'unauthorized alien' before being released, his attorney said. A3

A question of motive As details emerge about the suspected shooter's extremist views, an FSU vigil drew an emotional crowd. A3

THE NATION **Autistic people** and their families used social media to push back on RFK Jr.'s remarks. A4 **An NIH researcher** into ultra-processed foods is retiring, citing censorship concerns. A5

THE WORLD **India is** making a cautious shift toward China as the U.S. becomes more unpredictable. A8 **At least 74** people were killed in U.S. strikes on a Yemeni oil port, the Houthis say. A10

THE ECONOMY **With tariffs** on China, which products are going to get more expensive for American consumers? A11 **Elon Musk**, who interacts with hundreds of accounts on X, has received inspiration for government policy from some of them. A12

THE REGION **Maryland Gov.** Wes Moore (D) met with officials in Japan and South Korea to practice sports diplomacy. B1 **A 74-year-old** pedestrian was killed, and the vehicle that hit her is linked to several outstanding tickets for moving violations. B1

STYLE **With egg prices** still high, these are your best (and worst) alternatives to dye for Easter. C1

SPORTS **Despite their gaudy** records, the Thunder, Celtics and Cavaliers will need to be on their guard to avoid a surprise in the NBA playoffs. D1

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